

HOW FAR HAVE I COME?

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Cooperate with addiction assessments and accept the diagnosis and treatment plan.
2. Increase awareness of positive changes made in sobriety.
3. Plan for further growth and positive change and reinforce self-confidence.

ADDITIONAL HOMEWORK THAT CAN BE APPLICABLE TO CLIENTS WHO EXPERIENCE TREATMENT RESISTANCE

- Am I Teaching My Children Addictive Patterns?
- Analyzing Acting-Out Behavior
- Consequences of Continuing Addictive Lifestyles
- Early Warning Signs of Relapse
- Identifying and Using Community Resources
- Identifying Relapse Triggers and Cues
- Setting and Pursuing Goals in Recovery
- Understanding My Defense Mechanisms
- Understanding Nonchemical Addictions
- What Do I Want for My Children?
- What Does Addiction Mean to Me?
- What's Addiction Got to Do with My Problems?

ADDITIONAL PROBLEMS FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE USEFUL

- Adult-Child-of-an-Alcoholic (ACOA) Traits
- Borderline Traits
- Depression

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

The “How Far Have I Come?” activity is designed for the client in early- to middle-stage recovery who has difficulty seeing his/her own progress and has problems with confidence in his/her ability to cope with life in recovery. Its approach is to guide the client in a structured assessment of his/her thoughts, feelings, behaviors, and coping skills at the time of entry into treatment and at the present, highlighting progress. This exercise is a good accompaniment to the activities titled “What Do Others

See “Changing?” and “Personal Recovery Planning.” Follow-up can include reviewing the client’s findings from this exercise with the therapist, treatment group, and program sponsor.

HOW FAR HAVE I COME?

Sometimes it's hard to see the changes that we're making. Often change comes gradually and is difficult to measure, and others may see our progress more easily than we can. This exercise will help you measure how much you've changed in different areas of your life since you began your recovery work.

1. Please describe how you were thinking, feeling, acting, and coping with difficulties in the following areas of your life _____ months ago (when you first began your recovery work).

Area of Life	Thoughts	Feelings	Actions	Coping Skills
Substance abuse				
Home/family				
Work/school				
Friendships				
Love relationships				

Area of Life	Thoughts	Feelings	Actions	Coping Skills
Legal situation				
Finances				
Communication with others				
Self-care				
Leisure activities				
Spiritual life				

2. Now describe how you are thinking, feeling, acting, and coping in the same areas today.

Area of Life	Thoughts	Feelings	Actions	Coping Skills
Substance abuse				

Area of Life	Thoughts	Feelings	Actions	Coping Skills
Home/family				
Work/school				
Friendships				
Love relationships				
Legal situation				
Finances				
Communication with others				
Self-care				
Leisure activities				

Area of Life	Thoughts	Feelings	Actions	Coping Skills
Spiritual life				

3. Where do you see the most change?

4. What changes are most surprising for you?

Be sure to bring this handout to your next therapy session, and be prepared to talk about your thoughts and feelings about the exercise.